

D358

Global Human Resource Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A U.S.-based medical device company with plants in 11 countries decides that each subsidiary will be run by a manager from that subsidiary's own country, and headquarters will rarely move managers across borders. The CEO recently won an industry award. Its Mexican plant also passed a safety audit last spring. Which staffing orientation is this?

- A. Ethnocentric
- B. Geocentric
- C. Regiocentric
- D. Polycentric

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm fills its top subsidiary jobs with whoever is best qualified, regardless of nationality, and moves talent freely among all its units. Which staffing orientation does it follow?

- A. Geocentric
- B. Polycentric
- C. Regiocentric
- D. Ethnocentric

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A Canadian software firm sends a Brazilian engineer who has worked at its Toronto headquarters for six years to lead its new office in Poland. The engineer speaks four languages and is known for strong client skills. In the Poland office, which employee category is the engineer?

- A. Host-country national
- B. Third-country national
- C. Parent-country national
- D. An expatriate, which is a separate fourth category

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A German automaker's plant in Alabama hires an engineer who is a U.S. citizen and lives in Alabama. Which category is the engineer?

- A.** Parent-country national
- B.** Third-country national
- C.** Host-country national
- D.** Expatriate

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A manager used to flat teams where junior staff openly challenge the boss takes over a team abroad. The team's office is in a new building near the airport, and the team hit its sales target last year. Staff wait for her to make every decision, address her by title, and rarely question her in meetings. Which Hofstede dimension best explains the team's behavior?

- A.** High power distance
- B.** High uncertainty avoidance
- C.** Low power distance
- D.** Collectivism

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A U.S. project lead sends a Japanese partner a detailed proposal. The partner, whose firm has 900 employees and a strong safety record, replies, 'This will be very difficult; we will study it further.' The U.S. lead tells headquarters the partner is still open to the deal. What most likely explains the misunderstanding?

- A.** The U.S. lead comes from a high-context culture and read too much into the reply.
- B.** A 900-person firm needs more approval layers, so the reply was only a delay.
- C.** Japanese business partners never say no in any form.
- D.** The partner used high-context communication; the polite reply likely meant no, and the meaning was in the context rather than the words.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which communication practice is most typical of a low-context culture?

- A.** Declining requests indirectly to preserve harmony.
- B.** Detailed written contracts that spell out every term.
- C.** Using formal titles and deferring to rank.
- D.** Relying on relationship history and nonverbal cues to carry meaning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An engineer relocates to Singapore on a three-year assignment with a 20% salary premium. The first two months feel exciting. By month four she feels frustrated, homesick, and irritable with local colleagues. Using the U-curve model, what stage is she in, and what usually comes next?

- A.** Reverse culture shock.
- B.** Culture shock; with support, adjustment and then mastery usually follow.
- C.** Honeymoon; culture shock comes next.
- D.** Culture shock, which always ends the assignment early.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A company sends a manager from Dallas to Zurich. In Dallas, comparable housing costs him \$2,400 a month. In Zurich, equivalent housing costs \$4,100 a month. He is a strong performer with a pending promotion, and the company uses the balance-sheet approach. What monthly housing allowance keeps him whole?

- A.** \$6,500
- B.** \$4,100
- C.** \$1,700
- D.** \$1,700 plus a performance premium

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under the balance-sheet approach, what is the goal of expatriate pay?

- A.** Pay the same base salary with no allowances.
- B.** Always put the expatriate well ahead of peers back home.
- C.** Pay exactly the host-country local market rate.
- D.** Keep the expatriate's home-country living standard so the move neither helps nor hurts financially.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A packaged-food company adapts recipes, packaging, marketing and HR policies separately for each country and lets each national subsidiary run almost independently. Its stock rose 8% last year, and it recently opened a research center in Ireland. Which international strategy does this describe?

- A.** Multidomestic
- B.** Global
- C.** International
- D.** Transnational

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A U.S. company opens an office in France. Its U.S. handbook gives 10 days of paid vacation; French law requires five weeks of paid annual leave. The office manager, a U.S. citizen with 15 years in the company, wants to apply the handbook to keep policies consistent. What should HR do?

- A.** Apply U.S. policy because the office manager is a U.S. citizen.
- B.** Negotiate a middle figure, such as three and a half weeks.
- C.** Give French staff at least the five weeks required by French law; policy may exceed local law but not fall below it.
- D.** Apply the U.S. handbook because the employer is a U.S. company.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A U.S.-based medical device company with plants in 11 countries decides that each subsidiary will be run by a manager from that subsidiary's own country, and headquarters will rarely move managers across borders. ~~The CEO recently won an industry award. Its Mexican plant also passed a safety audit last spring.~~ Which staffing orientation is this?

Target word: name the staffing orientation **Decides:** Locals run each subsidiary and managers rarely move across borders.

A	Inverted operation	Ethnocentric sends home-country managers to run subsidiaries, the opposite of this policy.
B	Confusion set	Geocentric picks the best person from anywhere and moves talent freely; this firm limits cross-border moves.
C	Adjacent category	Regiocentric moves managers within a region; here each country is staffed only by its own nationals.
D	Correct	Host-country nationals manage their own subsidiaries; headquarters stays home-country run.

2. Answer A Concept 1 · transfer

A firm fills its top subsidiary jobs with whoever is best qualified, regardless of nationality, and moves talent freely among all its units. Which staffing orientation does it follow?

Target word: orientation from the policy — reverse direction **Decides:** Best person regardless of nationality, moving worldwide.

A	Correct	Nationality does not matter; talent is drawn from and moved across the whole company.
B	Confusion set	Polycentric keeps locals in their own country's units.
C	Adjacent category	Regiocentric limits movement to one region, not the whole company.
D	Inverted operation	Ethnocentric favors home-country nationals, the opposite of ignoring nationality.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A Canadian software firm sends a Brazilian engineer ~~who has worked at its Toronto headquarters for six years to lead its new office in Poland. The engineer speaks four languages and is known for strong client skills.~~ In the Poland office, which employee category is the engineer?

Target word: employee category at the host site **Decides:** Citizenship (Brazil) differs from both HQ (Canada) and host (Poland).

A	Confusion set	That would be a Polish citizen working in Poland.
B	Correct	A citizen of neither the parent country nor the host country.
C	Camouflage	Answers the years at Toronto headquarters; category depends on citizenship, not where the person worked before.
D	Adjacent category	Expatriate describes anyone sent abroad; PCNs and TCNs can both be expatriates.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A German automaker's plant in Alabama hires an engineer who is a U.S. citizen and lives in Alabama. Which category is the engineer?

Target word: category when the host country is the parent's foreign site **Decides:** Citizenship matches the host country (U.S.), not HQ (Germany).

A	Inverted operation	The parent country is Germany; the engineer is not German.
B	Confusion set	A TCN is from neither the parent nor the host country.
C	Correct	A U.S. citizen working at the company's U.S. site.
D	Adjacent category	The engineer has not relocated abroad; this is a local hire.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A manager used to flat teams where junior staff openly challenge the boss takes over a team abroad. ~~The team's office is in a new building near the airport, and the team hit its sales target last year.~~ Staff wait for her to make every decision, address her by title, and rarely question her in meetings. Which Hofstede dimension best explains the team's behavior?

Target word: which cultural dimension **Decides:** Deference to the boss and acceptance of unequal authority.

A	Correct	Staff accept a large gap in authority and defer to the manager.
B	Confusion set	That is about discomfort with ambiguity and a need for rules, not deference to rank.
C	Inverted operation	Low power distance is what the manager is used to, where staff challenge the boss.
D	Adjacent category	Collectivism is loyalty to the group; the behavior here is about rank and authority.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A U.S. project lead sends a Japanese partner a detailed proposal. The partner, ~~whose firm has 900 employees and a strong safety record,~~ replies, 'This will be very difficult; we will study it further.' The U.S. lead tells headquarters the partner is still open to the deal. What most likely explains the misunderstanding?

Target word: why the message was misread **Decides:** Indirect wording from a high-context culture read literally by a low-context reader.

A	Inverted operation	The U.S. is typically low-context; the lead read too little into it, not too much.
B	Camouflage	Answers the firm-size detail, which does not explain the wording.
C	Absolute language	Refusals happen; they are usually indirect, not absent.
D	Correct	High-context speakers often decline indirectly to preserve harmony.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which communication practice is most typical of a low-context culture?

Target word: pick the low-context trait **Decides:** Meaning carried by explicit words.

A	Confusion set	Indirect refusals are a high-context trait.
B	Correct	Low-context cultures rely on explicit, precise wording.
C	Adjacent category	That reflects power distance, a different dimension.
D	Inverted operation	That describes high-context communication.

8. Answer B Concept 5

An engineer relocates to Singapore ~~on a three-year assignment with a 20% salary premium~~. The first two months feel exciting. By month four she feels frustrated, homesick, and irritable with local colleagues. Using the U-curve model, what stage is she in, and what usually comes next?

Target word: stage and next stage **Decides:** Excitement faded into frustration a few months in.

A	Adjacent category	Reverse culture shock happens after returning home, not during the assignment.
B	Correct	Frustration after the honeymoon is the low point of the U-curve.
C	Confusion set	The honeymoon was the first two months; she has moved past it.
D	Absolute language	Most expatriates move through culture shock, especially with employer support.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A company sends a manager from Dallas to Zurich. In Dallas, comparable housing costs him \$2,400 a month. In Zurich, equivalent housing costs \$4,100 a month. ~~He is a strong performer with a pending promotion~~, and the company uses the balance-sheet approach. What monthly housing allowance keeps him whole?

Target word: housing allowance **Decides:** Pay the difference between host and home housing cost.

A	Inverted operation	Adds the two costs instead of taking the difference.
B	Wrong stem number	The full Zurich cost; he would still pay his normal home-level share from salary.
C	Correct	$\$4,100 - \$2,400 = \$1,700$ keeps his housing standard equal to home.
D	Camouflage	Performance and promotion do not enter the balance-sheet allowance.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

Under the balance-sheet approach, what is the goal of expatriate pay?

Target word: purpose of the approach **Decides:** Keep home-country purchasing power.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the allowances that do the balancing.
B	Absolute language	Premiums may exist, but the balance sheet aims for equality, not a guaranteed gain.
C	Confusion set	That is localization, a different pay approach.
D	Correct	Allowances equalize housing, goods and tax differences.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A packaged-food company adapts recipes, packaging, marketing and HR policies separately for each country and lets each national subsidiary run almost independently. ~~Its stock rose 8% last year, and it recently opened a research center in Ireland~~. Which international strategy does this describe?

Target word: strategy type **Decides:** High local responsiveness, low global integration.

A	Correct	Each country unit adapts heavily and operates on its own.
B	Inverted operation	A global strategy standardizes worldwide with little local adaptation.
C	Confusion set	International exports home-country practices with little adaptation.
D	Adjacent category	Transnational seeks both high integration and high responsiveness; here integration is low.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A U.S. company opens an office in France. Its U.S. handbook gives 10 days of paid vacation; French law requires five weeks of paid annual leave. The office manager, ~~a U.S. citizen with 15 years in the company,~~ wants to apply the handbook to keep policies consistent. What should HR do?

Target word: which rule governs leave **Decides:** Local law sets a higher minimum than the handbook.

A	Camouflage	The manager's citizenship does not change the staff's legal rights.
B	Adjacent category	Treats a legal minimum as a bargaining point.
C	Correct	Host-country law governs employment at the work site.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses which law controls; the work site's law applies.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	International staffing orientations	Ethnocentric = home-country managers run key jobs everywhere; polycentric = locals run each subsidiary; regiocentric = talent moves within a region; geocentric = best person for the job regardless of nationality.	Calling any policy that uses local managers geocentric.	Who fills the top subsidiary jobs, and whether people move across borders.
2	PCN, HCN and TCN	Classify by nationality relative to headquarters and the work location: parent-country, host-country, or third-country national.	Classifying by where the person worked before or where the company hired them.	Three countries named in one stem: HQ, the job site, and the person's citizenship.
3	Hofstede's cultural dimensions	Power distance = acceptance of unequal power; individualism = self vs. group; uncertainty avoidance = comfort with ambiguity; each explains a different workplace behavior.	Explaining deference to the boss with uncertainty avoidance or collectivism.	Behavior toward bosses, groups, or rules and ambiguity.
4	High-context vs. low-context communication	High-context cultures carry meaning in relationships, setting and indirect cues; low-context cultures put the meaning in explicit words.	Taking an indirect, polite reply at face value.	A soft or vague answer that one side reads literally.
5	Expatriate adjustment (U-curve)	Adjustment runs honeymoon, then culture shock, then adjustment, then mastery; support in the culture-shock stage (including for the family) prevents early return.	Treating culture shock as proof the assignment has failed.	Early excitement followed by frustration a few months in.
6	Balance-sheet approach to expatriate pay	Keep the expatriate's home-country purchasing power: pay the difference between host and home costs for housing, goods and taxes.	Paying the full host-country cost, or paying the local market rate.	Home cost and host cost for the same item in one stem.
7	Global integration vs. local responsiveness	Multidomestic = high local responsiveness, low integration; global = high integration, low responsiveness; transnational = high on both; international = low on both, exporting home practices.	Calling any company in many countries global.	How much each country unit adapts vs. follows headquarters.
8	Host-country employment law sets the floor	Local law governs employment at the work site; company policy may be more generous but not below local legal minimums.	Applying the headquarters handbook everywhere for consistency.	A home-country policy that is less generous than the host country's law.

Course scope (public description): Organizations increasingly operate across borders, and HR professionals must be prepared to manage people in diverse cultural and legal environments. This course introduces you to international HR practices, global talent management, and cross- cultural communication. You will learn how to adapt HR strategies to different regions and cultures, making you a valuable asset to any organization with a global reach.